Harshitha Arul

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ABOUT ME

Curious and driven student passionate about technology, STEM, business, and innovation. Experienced in AI, cybersecurity, networking, and project development, with a strong record of academic achievement, leadership, and service. I bring a hardworking, creative, and positive mindset to every opportunity and hope to use technology and problem-solving to create meaningful impact.

EDUCATION

Panther Creek High School - Senior GPA: 4.411

- Completed advanced coursework including AP U.S. Government, AP Statistics, AP Pre-Calculus, AP Environmental Science, AP Language & Composition, and AP Calculus AB
- Enrolled in multiple AP and Honors courses demonstrating academic excellence and drive
- **Dual Faculty Choice Award** for excellence in WCPSS core characteristics and for dedication to science and its real-world application
- Wake Tech College Courses – UX Design, Cybersecurity, Network & Security Foundations, Information Systems Business Foundations, Microeconomics, Art Appreciation

TECHNICAL & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Cisco Networking Academy & Cisco Certifications

- Cisco Certified Support Technician - Networking, score: 994/1000
- Completed Cisco Networking Academy course on Network & Security Foundations

AI, Computer Science & Technology Programs

- Duke University – Advances in AI (2025)
  - Collaborated with Duke researchers on AI capstone projects
  - Co-developed an ethical AI initiative
  - Authored a policy-oriented letter to a U.S. Congresswoman advocating responsible AI use
- Harvard CS50 (edX)
  - Completed globally recognized computer science coursework, mastering algorithms, programming fundamentals, and problem-solving

CERTIFICATIONS

- PMI Project Management Ready, score: 960/1000
- CPR Certified, American Heart Association (2025)

HONORS & RECOGNITION

- Soft Skills Credentials & Dual $150 Award for Career Accelerator Camp
- AP Scholar
- AP Scholar with Distinction
- Two-time Winner of Faculty Choice Award

STEM & CAREER EXPLORATION

Cisco High School Externship Program

- One of the top students in the group of 30 that got selected over 600 applicants to be immersed in understanding Cisco and its people, culture and global impact on AI Infrastructure, Networking and Security areas. Successfully completed a capstone project demonstrating how to leverage AI and Cisco technologies to help, any company modernize and solve problems in today's world. Learned a lot about Cisco's culture, networking, and met with many directors and executive leaders to understand how technology is changing their life and everyone's life around the globe. Gained clarity on the successful career pathways for the future.

Career Accelerator Camps

- Earned soft-skills credential and stipend; completed biotech and professional development tracks; visited FUJIFILM Diosynth and NC State labs, strengthened networking, elevator pitching, and career readiness skills

SWE Fest at Duke University

- Participated in engineering workshops hosted by Duke, UNC, NCSU, and ECU; explored engineering pathways through hands-on sessions

Great Explorations Career Fair

- Built real-world networking skills and engaged with STEM professionals, including a leading physician and science educator

Girls Who Code Summer Program

- Explored CS through hands-on projects, strengthening coding, problem-solving, and collaboration while expanding my confidence in STEM.

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEERING

NC Spinal Cord Injury Association

- Supported the Raw Beauty Project and Wheelchair Rugby Tournament through logistics, coordination, and community engagement

NC Museum of Natural Sciences

- Operated Mars Rover Lunar Lander station; served as Spanish translator; contributed to BugFest, engaging hundreds of visitors in STEM learning and hands-on exploration

Alston Ridge Middle School & NC Natya Darpan Event

- Supported event setup, cleanup, and hospitality for 100+ attendees

APS Dog Shelter

- Ongoing volunteer supporting animal care and operations

Step Up Tutoring

- Tuition-free tutoring for many children across America

PASSION PROJECT

PACE - AI-Powered Personalized Study Planner

- Developed an AI-powered personalized study planner with a team of friends to help students balance academics, extracurriculars, deadlines, and outside responsibilities.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Grader/Substitute/Admin - Best Brains

- Mentored 30 learners; Graded 400+ student assignments; strengthened communication, adaptability, & leadership while students achieve academic progress

CLUBS & ACTIVITIES

DECA - State Qualifier

- Competed in business, finance, and entrepreneurship events; advanced to state level; earned Proficiency Award

Key Club

- Active in community service and leadership initiatives; contributor to Innovation Through Service Project

Badminton Club

- Built teamwork, discipline, and sportsmanship through consistent practice

FemSTEM Representative

- Promoted equity and inclusion in STEM for women and underrepresented students; led outreach and advocacy efforts

DECA Energy Industry Project

- Conducted research on employment pathways in the energy sector to raise awareness of this field to future workforce

PERSONAL ENRICHMENT

- Guitarist – Developed musical discipline, rhythm, and collaborative performance skills
- Writer – Builds a portfolio of essays, stories, and reflections; Uses writing for expression and critical thinking
- Tamil Language School – Cultural literacy and language proficiency
- Swimming School – Endurance, discipline, and water safety mastery

SKILLS

Technical

- Cybersecurity fundamentals, networking basics, UX design, AI literacy, Cisco Packet Tracer

Communication

- Public speaking, professional writing, bilingual (English & Tamil), Spanish interpretation experience

Leadership

- Event management, teamwork, cross-cultural collaboration